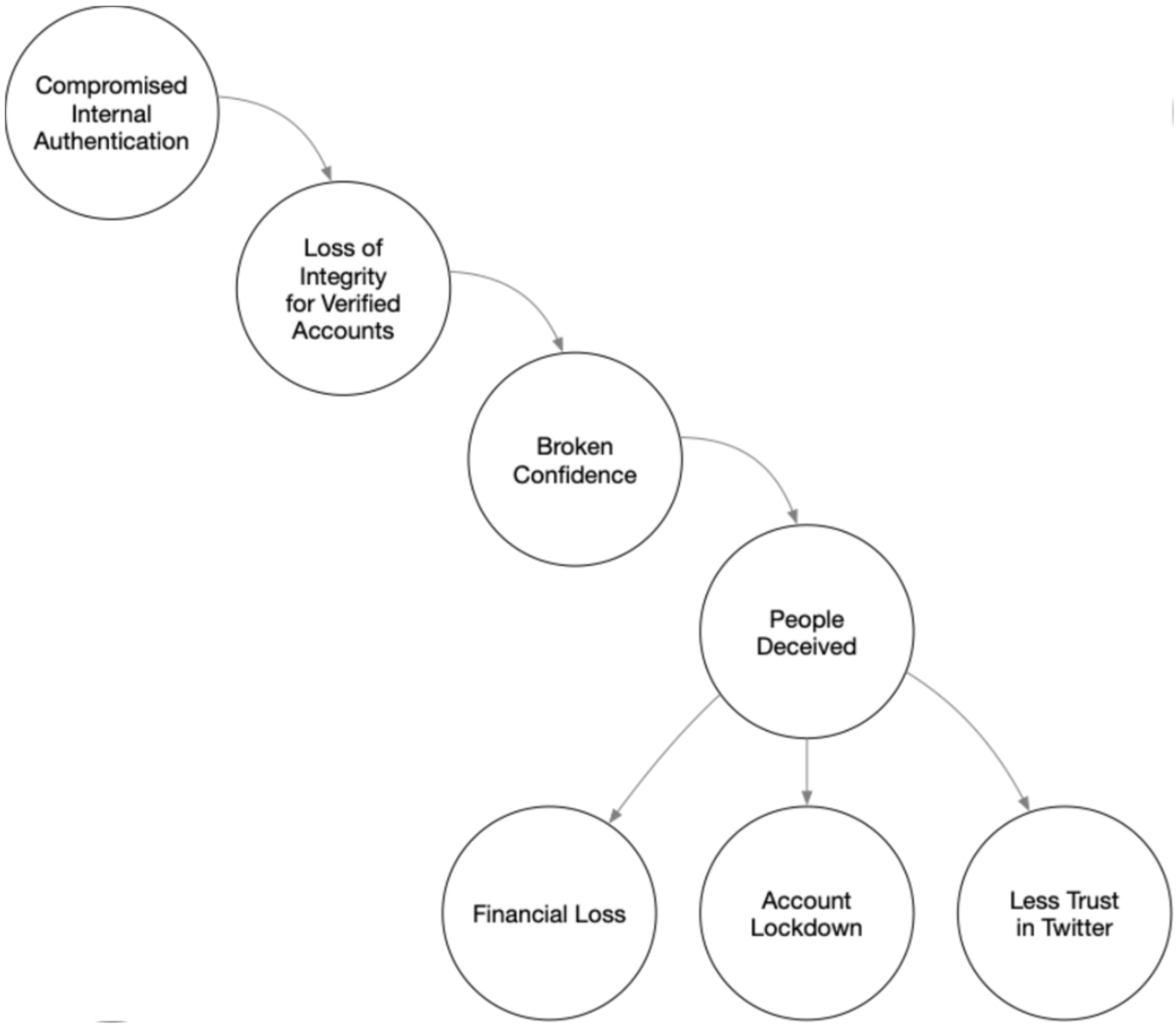


Figure 3.2 The cascade of consequences triggered by a loss of relationship integrity. Compromised internal authentication undermines the trusted relationship between administrators and the system, leading to a broader loss of integrity for verified accounts. As confidence diminishes, individuals are deceived—resulting in financial loss, account lockouts, and reduced trust in the platform.

Because of the proximity problem, preserving relationship integrity is vital to digital systems. Strong authentication ensures relationship integrity by verifying that the entity making a request is truly the account holder. Relationship integrity, established through reliable authentication, is foundational for making accurate authorization decisions and maintaining a trustworthy identity lifecycle. The next section will show the role of authentication throughout the account lifecycle.